

Project Sitara — Board Summary

Confidential · 28 July 2026 · Companion to Decks 1 & 2 and the Excel model

The opportunity

Two research phases (21 workstreams, ~670 sources) examined 14 categories and scored 20 business ideas on one weighted model. Three categories show proven, repeated, emotionally-driven spending by affluent Indians and NRIs: astrology/reassurance (AstroTalk: ₹1,182 Cr FY25 revenue, ₹250 Cr profit, 80% repeat), NRI eldercare (₹11,000–17,000/month incumbent subscriptions), and diaspora devotional services (NRI ARPU 10x domestic). The combined ranking: **Sitara 8.1 · Sahay 8.0 · KalaOS 7.6**, ahead of DharmaSetu 7.4 and Smriti 7.1. Ten further ideas were rejected on documented evidence (novelty collapse, frequency math, regulation, one-time purchase shape).

The recommendation

Build Sitara — a trust-first AI Vedic life-planning companion for NRI and affluent Indian women: daily chart-computed timing brief, compounding life-context memory, honest explanations, verified human-astrologer escalation, no fear-selling. Pricing \$99–199/yr (NRI) and ₹3,999–7,999/yr (India). It wins on the combination the board asked for: proven category spend, AI that demonstrably outperforms incumbent humans (4.6 vs 4.3 at ~90% margins), the lightest operations of any finalist (3/10), a documented trust vacuum, and a clear acquisition channel with published CAC benchmarks.

The financial case (base case, bottom-up model)

Customers: 3,231 (M12) → 8,552 (M24) → 14,544 (M36). Revenue: ₹1.42 Cr → ₹6.34 Cr → ₹12.16 Cr; exit ARR ≈ ₹14.8 Cr. Gross margin 79%. LTV ₹11,306 vs CAC ₹3,600 (3.1x; payback 5.3 months). EBITDA-positive in month 30; Y3 EBITDA +₹0.20 Cr; 3-year cumulative EBITDA – ₹4.63 Cr funded by staged capital. Peak staged funding ₹7.85 Cr in three gated tranches (₹1.25 Cr / ₹3.3 Cr / ₹3.3 Cr). Conservative case (churn 7.5%, CAC ₹4,500): no break-even in 36 months — capped by stop-loss at gates. Aggressive case (churn 4.5%): Y3 revenue ₹22.6 Cr, EBITDA +₹6.3 Cr, break-even M23.

The ask

Approve **₹1.25 crore (Scenario A)**: 12-week MVP + 50-user concierge validation + 500 founding members. Gates: concierge month-2 renewal ≥60%; founding 500 by month 6; CAC <₹4,000. **Stop-loss**: concierge M2 <40% or founding <250 — stop or pivot; exposure capped at ₹1.25 Cr (≈₹95L net of founding-member cash). Next decision: month-6 board review of cohort data for the ₹3.3 Cr launch tranche.

The three risks that matter

- (1) **Subscription conversion** — astrology spend is episodic today; the concierge gate tests it for under ₹10L before serious code.
- (2) **Churn** — every +1pt of monthly churn ≈ –

₹2.4 Cr of Y3 revenue; annual-first pricing and the calendar-anchored product design are the countermeasures. (3) **Incumbent response** — mitigated by the premium NRI niche incumbents cannot serve without cannibalising fear-driven consult revenue, and by speed.

Facts are cited in the research report; estimates and assumptions are labelled in the Excel model; all board-deck numbers recalculate from the Assumptions sheet.